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Office Memorandum • UNITED STATES GOVERNMENT

TO : P. G. Strong

DATE: 31 March 1953

FROM : F. C. Durant

SUBJECT: Unidentified Flying Objects

1. (Jack Heckert) telephoned yesterday and told me that O/CI is no longer following reports of U. F. O.'s. [Jack] has the O/CI file of U. F. O. dispatches and wanted suggestions as to where to send it. B-3

2. O/SI interest in U. F. O.'s is currently centered on Dave Stevenson (Air Branch/Applied Science Division). He is back-stopped by Lt. Col. Fritz Cder (Geophys Br/R&E Division). [Stevenson] has all O/SI files with exception of key documents, Panel Reports, etc. which are in the Operations Staff office. A-

3. It would seem wise for O/SI to keep a watch on U. F. C. reports in view of possibly greater activity this summer. The following steps are suggested to assign responsibility and insure receipt of intelligence information:

a. Designate Chief, Applied Science Division as coordinator of reports on U. F. O.'s with the suggestion that Mr. David B. Stevenson be named "action man". Carbon copy to Chief, R&E Division would request division support to [Stevenson] be coordinated by [Lt. Col. F. C. Cder].

b. Request O/CI turn files now in custody of [John Heckert] over to [Stevenson] for perusal. I believe very little material would be worth saving except as samples of indicative or unusual reports. The rest I recommend be destroyed. B-3

c. Request O/CI Screening Panel ([Miss Lowry]) I believe route all future messages pertaining to U. F. O.'s to the Applied Science Division, Attention: [D. B. Stevenson] for review.

4. The above method is believed the simplest method for O/SI effectively keeping tabs on the subject. There would be little time required on [Stevenson's] part to keep himself up to date. In the event of a future flap, his continuing watch should prove valuable in a critical analysis. From time to time he might report orally to you or to me on the status quo but no formal reports seem indicated.

RELEASED

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5. If the above plan appears suitable and you so desire, I'll prepare directive memos.


F. C. DURANT

OSI/FCDurant:bm

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J. C. Durant